

Job Posting: 467014 - Position: Software Engineering Assistant [Startup]

Co-op Work Term Posted:	2026 - Fall
App Deadline	05/19/2026 09:00 AM
Application Method:	WaterlooWorks
Posting Goes Live:	05/09/2026 09:00 AM
Job Posting Status:	Approved

Company Information

Organization	Mechanize Inc
Division	Divisional Office

Job Posting Information

Work Term	2026 - Fall
Job Type	Co-op Main
Job Title	Software Engineering Assistant [Startup]
Number of Job Openings	20
Level	Junior Intermediate Senior
Region	USA - West
Job - Address Line One	201 Third Street
Job - City	San Francisco
Job - Province/State	California
Job - Postal/Zip Code	94103
Job - Country	United States
Employment Location Arrangement	In-person
Work Term Duration	8 month consecutive work term preferred
Special Job Requirements	

Students are responsible for ensuring they are eligible for an 8-month work term before applying. Please discuss your work/study sequence flexibility with your academic advisor as soon as possible.

The University of Waterloo has compiled [guidance and frequently asked questions](#) for co-op students planning to work in the U.S. Please review this important information before deciding to apply for a U.S. work term.

This work opportunity is based in the USA; therefore all applicants must determine whether they are eligible to work in the USA.

To check your eligibility go please visit our Work abroad co-op requirements webpage (opens in a new window) and read the information listed in its entirety before you apply for this job. Be aware of mandatory and other requirements for students working outside Canada.

For specific information on the USA visa process that affects co-op employment, refer to our USA Work Permit/J-1 Visa webpage (opens in a new window).

Job Summary

Mechanize builds environments and evals for training and evaluating frontier coding agents.

No prior machine learning or AI experience is required.

Read about how our interview process works here: <https://www.mechanize.work/how-our-interview-process-works/>

Job Responsibilities

Interns at Mechanize assist our team in creating environments for training and evaluating coding agents. You might be a good fit if you can code in Python and you're highly intelligent.

Required Skills

Competency with AI coding tools.

Transportation and Housing

Software Engineering Assistants will provide their own housing.

Compensation and Benefits

\$100/hr

Application Information

Application Delivery

WaterlooWorks

Additional Application Information

At Mechanize we have a streamlined interview process that can be completed fully remotely. There are 3 stages, consisting of 5 hours in total. We encourage candidates to schedule each stage at the earliest time that works for them. We're often able to accommodate same-day scheduling, and the entire process can be completed within a few days.

After you submit your application, we will review it and decide whether to advance you to the first stage. If we decide to advance you, we'll invite you to schedule the first interview stage at a time that works for you.

Stage 1: Intro call (30 minutes)

One of our recruiters will have a call with you to discuss your background and experience, walk through what we do at Mechanize, and answer any questions you have about the company or the role. We'll decide whether to move you to the next round based on our impression from this conversation.

Stage 2: Take-home project (4 hours)

We ask you to implement a web app within 3 hours. You are allowed to use AI coding tools to help you. Afterwards, if we think you made sufficient progress on the assignment, we will take a 1 hour call with you and ask you questions about the code you produced. The goal is to assess whether you're capable of making rapid progress on software engineering tasks and whether you understand your own code. We only use your submission to evaluate your application.

Please note that, to be efficient, we might end an interview early if we think there is no further point in continuing it.

Stage 3: Meet the team (30 minutes)

One of our team members (typically our CEO) will have a call with you. The goal is for us to get to know each other and for you to ask any questions you have about the role or the company.

Offer

If you pass all three stages, we will likely make you an offer to work at Mechanize as a software engineer. We encourage you to start as soon as possible, and we can usually accommodate a start date as early as the day after you receive your offer.